

BRAND GUIDELINES

Composer Atlas

A reference instrument, not a growth story. An identity built from the measured vocabulary of real cartography.

Version 1.0 · 28 September 2026 · Concept work, not yet adopted

Mapped territory

Thousands of automated strategies charted and navigable, so a reader can understand one before committing money to it.

The product's promise is specific and it is not a promise about returns: the drawdown printed next to the return rather than beneath it. That sentence rules out most of what this category's logos do, because a site whose first principle is transparency over hype cannot open with a picture of going up.

Primary audience

Self-directed retail investors already using Composer, who want to understand a strategy before cloning it.

Secondary

Systematic-investing learners who know what a moving average is but have never built a strategy.

Position

An independent reference. Worth more, not less, now that the platform it documents has been acquired.

What everyone else does

Eight brands were analysed across retail systematic investing, screeners, backtesters and research publishers. They converge hard.

THEY SHARE	WHAT IT SIGNALS	WHY IT IS OUT
The upward-right arrow, rising line, candlestick or bar ramp	Performance	It is a claim about returns. This site does not make one
Blue as the primary	Finance trust	The category default, and now specifically the acquirer's territory
Globes, pins, compass roses, folded paper	"Atlas"	The four most obvious drawings. One of them is the emoji this replaces
Rounded geometric sans, gradients, glow	Consumer startup	This competes with research houses for credibility, not with a neobank for warmth

The opening. Two of the eight are trusted precisely because they look like instruments rather than products, and one earns institutional authority through pure restraint. The decorated end of the category belongs to businesses selling a feeling about money. This site sells an accurate picture, so restraint is the honest expression of the product rather than a style preference laid over it.

Four words, all of them real

The obvious vocabulary for "atlas" was ruled out, so the mark is built from terms a cartographer would recognise. Every shape in the system is one of these four.

Neatline

The border that frames a map plate. Every real map has one. Almost no logo does.

Parallel

A line of latitude. Straight and horizontal, which is the calm axis.

Meridian

A line of longitude. It bows away from centre, and that bow is the whole argument.

Index cell

One cell of the graticule, filled. An atlas finds a place by its cell reference.

The bow is the load-bearing decision. A grid of straight lines is a spreadsheet, and a spreadsheet is the wrong metaphor for a product that argues numbers need context. Curve the interior meridians the way a pseudocylindrical projection does and the same grid becomes a map. Nothing else in the mark carries that meaning, and removing it would leave a table.

Four directions, judged from renders

Every concept was rasterised at 16, 32 and 512 pixels, in colour and in grayscale, on light and dark grounds, and judged from the screenshot. Never from the drawing.



A · Neatline

Frame plus one green parallel. Clean and confident large. **Fails at 16px:** the parallel vanishes and it becomes an empty rectangle.



C · Index cell

The full 3x3 graticule with one located cell. The strongest mark at size. Fills into a smudge at 16px.



D · Evolved

The same graticule at 2x2 with a heavier stroke and a deeper bow. The only version that holds at 16px.

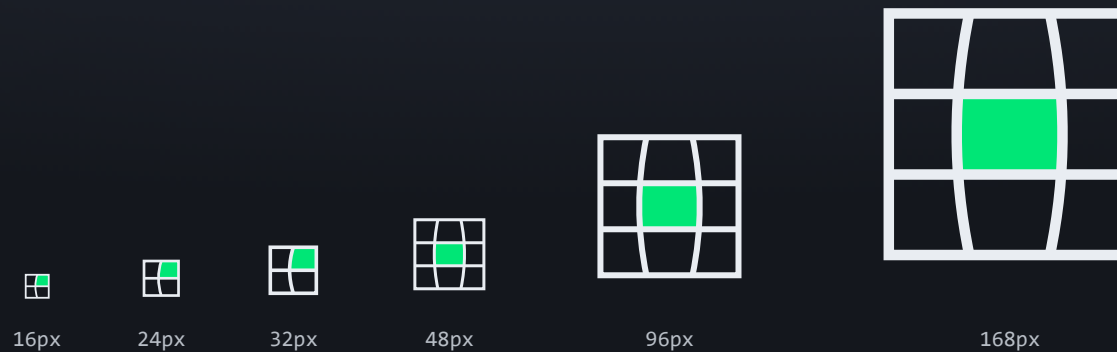
B · Wordmark

Archivo SemiBold caps, hand-kerned, the word space replaced by a green graticule tick. Locks up with either symbol.

One concept was corrected rather than defended. The wordmark originally ran a rule through each O's counter. It rendered as a slashed Scandinavian O and the word read `CØMPOSER`. It was removed outright, not thinned, because a detail that changes which letters a reader sees is not a detail, and a lighter version of it would fail the same way more quietly.

Not four rivals. One system.

C and D are the same idea at two levels of detail, and the render check is what proved it.



The primary mark carries the projection and the located cell. Below 33 pixels its eight interior gaps merge, so the compact mark takes over: the same neatline, the same bow,

the same green cell, with two divisions instead of eight. **A reader who meets both never registers the substitution**, which is the only test a responsive logo has to pass.

Lockups



COMPOSER | ATLAS

Horizontal

The default. Minimum 288px wide, set by the symbol rather than by the type.



COMPOSER | ATLAS

Stacked

For square and narrow spaces. Minimum 120px wide.

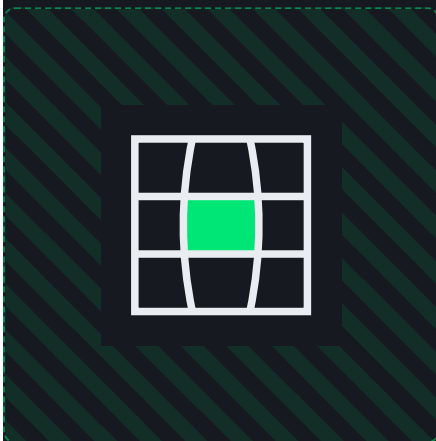
ASSET	MINIMUM	WHAT SETS THE FLOOR
Compact symbol	16px	The lowest size anything here survives, verified from a 16px render
Primary symbol	32px	Below it the interior gaps merge
Wordmark alone	120px wide	Cap height drops under 8px and Archivo's counters close

Horizontal lockup	288px wide	The symbol occupies the full height, so its 32px floor becomes the lockup's 288px floor. Use the compact lockup below this
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Stacked lockup	120px wide	Cap height
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Clear space

One graticule cell on every side, which is the mark's own unit rather than an arbitrary ratio. Nothing else enters that box.



One accent, and it means something

The palette was rebuilt with every step solved for a measured contrast ratio. The logo does not introduce a colour; it borrows the one the product already uses, in a third role the original rule did not anticipate: green as identity rather than green as a value.

Base
#16191f

Surface
#2c3038

Raised
#373c46

Primary text
#e9edf2

Green
#00e676

The constraint that follows from it. On the site, green means a positive number or a primary action. So the mark never pairs green with an arrow, a rising line, or anything else that reads as a value, or the logo would start making a performance claim on every page it appears on.

TREATMENT	INK	ACCENT	USE
Colour	#16191f	#00e676	Light grounds
Colour reversed	#e9edf2	#00e676	Dark grounds, including the site
Mono black	#16191f	collapses to ink	One-plate print, fax, engraving

Mono white

#e9edf2

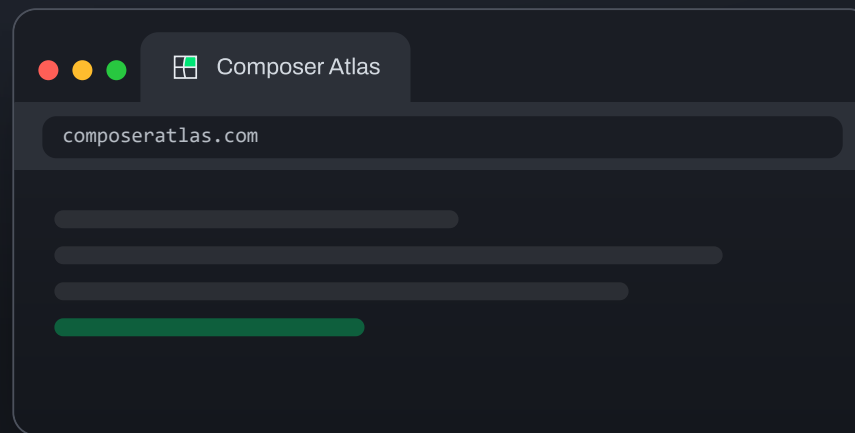
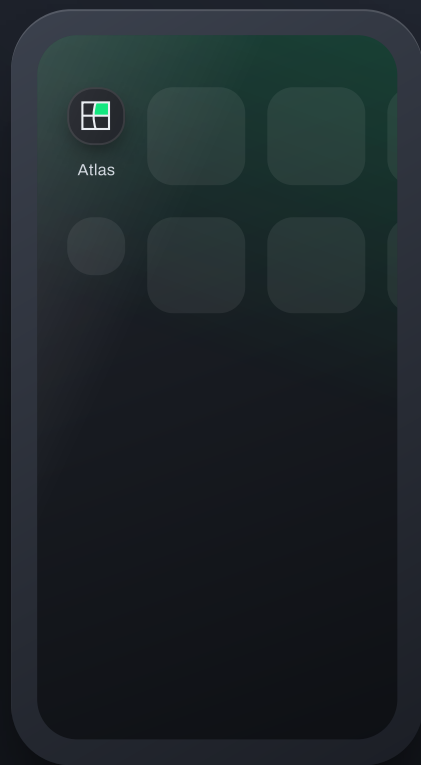
collapses to ink

Reversed one-colour

The single-colour versions keep the filled cell because it is a **fill against open cells**, not one hue beside another. It survives being flattened, photocopied or stitched.

Where it has to work

This brand has never been photographed, so nothing below is a photograph. Each surface is drawn, and each one is a size or a medium that has already changed a decision in this system.





Composer Atlas

composeratlas.com



The patch is the reason the merchandise file exists. Reproduced 25mm wide, the primary mark's stroke is 1.09mm. That survives print and does not survive an embroidery head, so merchandise uses the compact mark, whose stroke is 1.96mm and whose narrowest gap is 11.4mm. Both clear the 1mm floor.

How to keep it intact

DO

- ✓ Use the compact mark at 32px and below, and for anything stitched or engraved
- ✓ Leave one graticule cell of clear space on every side
- ✓ Reverse to the light ink on any ground darker than the surface colour
- ✓ Use the supplied single-colour files when a process cannot hold the green
- ✓ Keep the green for the index cell and the word tick, and nothing else

DO NOT

- ✗ Set the primary mark below 32px, where the gaps merge into a smudge
- ✗ Recolour the cell, or add a second accent
- ✗ Straighten the meridians. Without the bow it is a table
- ✗ Add a gradient, glow, shadow or outline. The system has none by design
- ✗ Rebuild the lockup by hand, or respace the wordmark
- ✗ Place the mark beside an arrow or a rising line

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Wordmark set in Archivo by Omnibus-Type, SIL Open Font License 1.1.